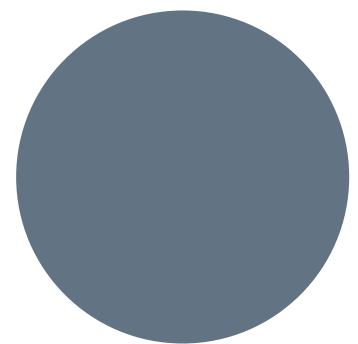
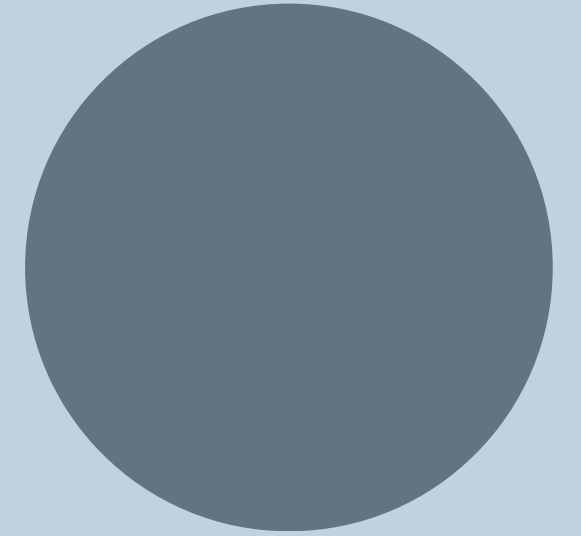


Data Analytics For

Understanding Gen-Z Career Aspirations



By Somesh Kumar Das



Roadmap

1 Problem Statement

Developed a problem statement to explore and educate about the career aspirations of Gen-Z, addressing challenges and personal insights.

3 Data Cleaning & Standardization

Followed a structured process of understanding, cleaning, standardizing, and validating the data to make it analysis-ready.

5 Analyzing in SQL

Conducted data analysis using SQL, solving complex questions with the help of Common Table Expressions (CTEs) and joins.

7 Functional Power BI Dashboard

Developed two focused dashboards for Gen-Z Mission Aspirations & Gen-Z Manager Aspirations, incorporating KPIs, Power Query Editor, slicers, and groups in Power BI.

2 Data collection

Created a Google Form with tailored questions to collect data on Gen-Z's career aspirations.

4 Exploratory Data Analytics

EDA was performed in Excel using data cleaning, pivot tables, and charts to analyze Gen-Z career trends, including preferences, salary expectations, and work styles.

6 Executive Excel Dashboard

Created a Excel dashboard summarizing Gen-Z's Career aspirations using KPI's, Comparison Charts and others.



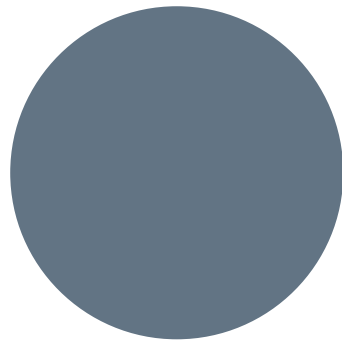


Problem Statement Documentation



STAGE

1



5W1H FRAMEWORK

What

- Preferred industries and career paths
- Expectations regarding work-life balance
- Attitudes toward remote and flexible work
- Key motivators such as financial stability, passion, and social impact

Why

- They are entering the workforce in large numbers
- Companies struggle with attraction and retention
- Educational programs need modernization
- Workforce trends are rapidly evolving

Who

- Gen Z individuals (students and early-career professionals)
- Employers (for hiring insights)
- Educators (for curriculum design)



5W1H FRAMEWORK

When

- Start: June 2025
- End: December 2025
- Phases:
 - Data Collection: 3 months
 - Analysis & Reporting: 2months

Where

- Primary focus: United States
- Key urban hubs: New York, Los Angeles, Chicago
- Data collection via online platforms to enable broader participation
- Potential expansion to global contexts

How

- Online surveys
- Interviews (20 participants)
- Statistical & qualitative analysis
- Ensure privacy
- Confidentiality
- Voluntary participation



Factors contributing to this change in Gen Z

1. Digital-Native Upbringing

- Grew up with internet, smartphones, and social media
- More aware of global opportunities and alternative careers
- Comfortable with remote work and digital jobs

2. Desire for Work-Life Balance

- Prioritizes mental health and flexibility
- Prefers hybrid/remote work over rigid schedules

3. Purpose-Driven Mindset

- Values jobs aligned with personal beliefs
- Strong interest in sustainability and social impact

4. Economic Uncertainty

- Exposure to events like the COVID-19 pandemic
- Leads to preference for stability + multiple income streams

5. Rise of Gig & Creator Economy

- Influenced by platforms like YouTube, Instagram, and TikTok
- Interest in freelancing, content creation, and entrepreneurship

6. Access to Online Education

- Platforms like Coursera and Udemy
- Enables skill-based careers over traditional degrees

7. Changing Workplace Expectations

- Prefers inclusive, diverse, and flexible workplaces
- Values transparency & growth opportunities

References

Research Reports

- Deloitte – Gen Z and Millennial Survey (2023/2024)
- McKinsey & Company – Future of Work Reports
- World Economic Forum – Future of Jobs Report

Workforce & Career Insights

- LinkedIn – Workforce & Gen Z career trend reports
- Gallup – Workplace engagement studies
- Pew Research Center – Generational behavior insights

Education & Skills

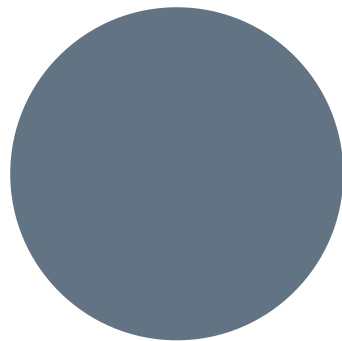
OECD – Education and skills outlook
UNESCO – Education trends and youth studies



Data Collection



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2



Mode of Collection: Google Form

What is your expected starting monthly salary? *

- ☐ Below ₹20,000
- ☐ ₹20,000–₹40,000
- ☐ ₹40,000–₹70,000
- ☐ Above ₹70,000

What work style do you prefer? *

- ☐ Remote
- ☐ Hybrid
- ☐ In-office

What influences your career decisions most? *

- ☐ Family
- ☐ Social media
- ☐ Friends
- ☐ Personal interest

What is your biggest challenge in getting a job? *

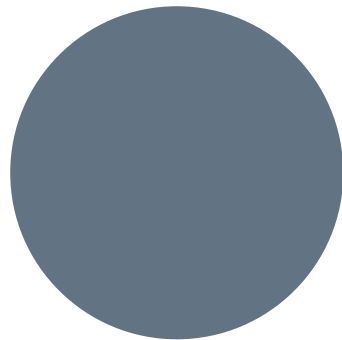
- ☐ Lack of experience
- ☐ Lack of skills
- ☐ Competition
- ☐ Location
- ☐ Other



Data Cleaning & Standardization



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3



Steps involved in Data Cleaning

1. Load Data Set in MS Excel

Your Current Count	Your Current Zip Code / Pin Code	Your Gender	Which of the below factors influence the most about your career aspirations ?
India	273005	Male	People who have changed the world for better
India	851129	Male	People who have changed the world for better
India	123106	Female	Social Media like LinkedIn
India	834003	Male	People from my circle, but not family members
India	301019	Female	Influencers who had successful careers
India	768028	Female	My Parents
India	301019	Male	People from my circle, but not family members
India	722207	Male	People from my circle, but not family members
India	400022	Male	People from my circle, but not family members
India	201310	Male	Social Media like LinkedIn
India	679121	Male	People from my circle, but not family members

2. Rename Column Headers:

Response Time	Country	Pincode	Gender	Career Influence Factors
12/16/2022 11:46	India	851129	Male	People who changed the world
12/16/2022 11:55	India	123106	Female	Social Media & Influencers
12/16/2022 11:58	India	834003	Male	Friend Circle
12/16/2022 11:59	India	301019	Female	Social Media & Influencers
12/16/2022 11:59	India	768028	Female	Family

3. Clean Data Values

Study Abroad Intent ▾	3yrs Likelihood ▾	Work Without Mission ▾	Mission Misaligned Company ▾
Cost Issues	Yes	No	Will NOT work for them
Yes	Yes	Yes	Will work for them
Cost Issues	Yes	No	Will NOT work for them
Cost Issues	Yes	No	Will NOT work for them
Yes	Yes	No	Will NOT work for them
Cost Issues	Yes	Yes	Will work for them
Cost Issues	Yes	No	Will work for them
Cost Issues	Yes	Yes	Will NOT work for them
Cost Issues	Yes	Yes	Will work for them
Yes	Yes	Yes	Will work for them
Cost Issues	Yes	No	Will NOT work for them
Cost Issues	Yes	Yes	Will work for them
Yes	Yes	No	Will NOT work for them
Yes	Yes	Yes	Will NOT work for them
Cost Issues	Yes	No	Will NOT work for them
Yes	Yes	No	Will NOT work for them
Yes	Yes	No	Will NOT work for them
Yes	Yes	No	Will work for them
Yes	No way	No	Will NOT work for them

4. Handle Missing Values

- Identify blank/null cells
- Replace with “Not Specified” (for categorical data)
- Remove unnecessary columns (e.g., Email)

5. Format Data Types

Response Time ▾	Country ▾	Pincode ▾
12/16/2022 11:46	India	851129
12/16/2022 11:55	India	123106
12/16/2022 11:58	India	834003
12/16/2022 11:59	India	301019

6. Split into Rows

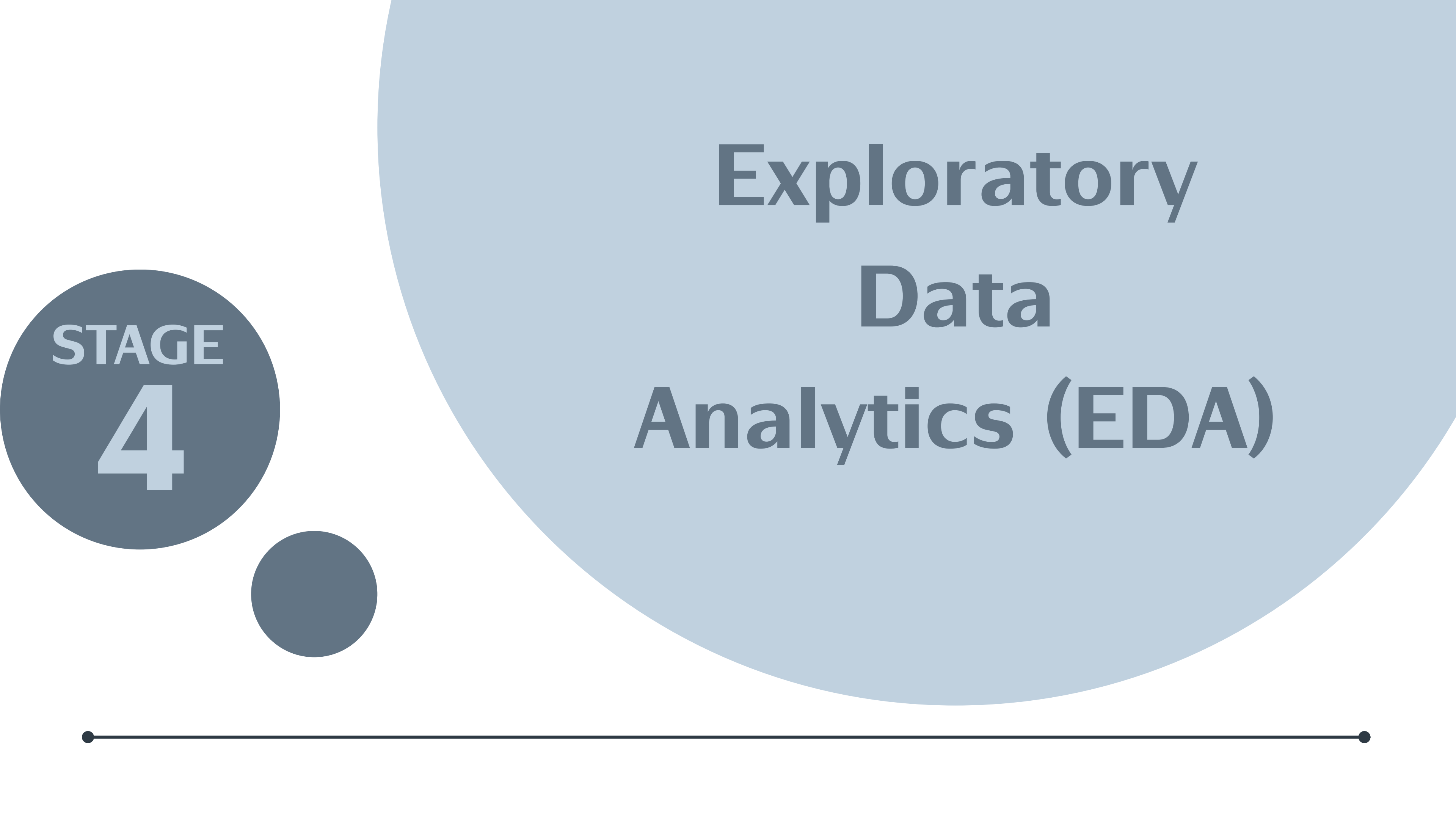
Career Goal 1	Career Goal 2	Career Goal 3
Designing	Data Analysis	Manage End-to-End Projects
Designing	Designing	Designing
Designing	Business Operations	Designing
Designing	Manage End-to-End Projects	Designing
Designing	Designing	Designing
Business Operations	Designing	Data Analysis
Designing	Business Operations	Teaching
Designing	Designing	Business Operations
Designing	Designing	Designing
Manage End-to-End Projects	Manage End-to-End Projects	Manage End-to-End Projects
Designing	Business Operations	Designing
Designing	Business Operations	Teaching
Business Operations	Designing	Business Operations
Designing	Software Developer	Designing
Teaching	Designing	Designing
Designing	Designing	Teaching

7. Save Final Data

Preferred Working Environment	Employer Type	Larning Preference	Career Goal	Manager Type	Work Setup	Lys Likelihood	Jyrs Salary Expectatio
Fully Remote with Travel Options	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Self Paced Learning Portals	Business Operations	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 5-6 people	No way	21k to 25k
Hybrid with <15 Days at Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Self Paced Learning Portals	Manage End-to-End Projects	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 2-3 people	No way	21k to 25k
Hybrid with <15 Days at Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Expert Learning Programs	Business Operations	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 2-3 people	Depends on the company	>50k
Fully Remote with Travel Options	Supports Learning	Self Paced Learning Portals	Teaching	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 2-3 people	Depends on the company	31k to 40k
Fully Remote with Travel Options	Supports Learning	Expert Learning Programs	Business Operations	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 2-3 people	Yes	26k to 30k
Fully Remote with Travel Options	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Expert Learning Programs	Designing	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 5-6 people	No way	>50k
Hybrid with <15 Days at Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Self Paced Learning Portals	Business Operations	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 7-10 people	Depends on the company	16k to 20k
Fully Remote with Travel Options	High Growth, Learning Enabled with Rewards	Self Paced Learning Portals	Teaching	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 5-6 people	Depends on the company	26k to 30k
Everyday Office	Supports Learning	Self Paced Learning Portals	Business Operations	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work alone	Depends on the company	21k to 25k
Fully Remote with Travel Options	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Self Paced Learning Portals	Manage End-to-End Projects	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work alone	Depends on the company	21k to 25k
Fully Remote with Travel Options	Supports Learning	Self Paced Learning Portals	Software Developer	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work alone	Depends on the company	16k to 20k
Hybrid with <15 Days at Office	Supports Learning	Learning by observing others	Designing	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 2-3 people	Yes	41k to 50k
Fully Remote with Travel Options	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Self Paced Learning Portals	Designing	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 5-6 people	Depends on the company	41k to 50k
Hybrid with <15 Days at Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Self Paced Learning Portals	Designing	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 10+ people	Depends on the company	31k to 40k
Hybrid with <10 Days at Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Expert Learning Programs	Teaching	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 5-6 people	Depends on the company	16k to 20k
Hybrid with <15 Days at Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Self Paced Learning Portals	Designing	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 2-3 people	Depends on the company	>50k
Everyday Office	Supports Learning	Self Paced Learning Portals	Designing	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 5-6 people	No way	31k to 40k
Everyday Office	Supports Learning	Self Paced Learning Portals	Business Operations	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 10+ people	Depends on the company	>50k
Hybrid with <15 Days at Office	High Growth, Learning Enabled with Rewards	Expert Learning Programs	Business Operations	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work alone	Depends on the company	26k to 30k
Hybrid with <15 Days at Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Expert Learning Programs	Designing	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 5-6 people	Depends on the company	>50k
Everyday Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Self Paced Learning Portals	Designing	Clear Communicator	Work with 2-3 people	Depends on the company	>50k
Fully Remote with Travel Options	High Growth, Learning Enabled with Rewards	Self Paced Learning Portals	Designing	Clear Communicator	Work alone	Depends on the company	41k to 50k
Everyday Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Learning by observing others	Software Developer	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 7-10 people	No way	16k to 20k
Hybrid with <15 Days at Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Learning by observing others	Designing	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 5-6 people	Depends on the company	>50k
Fully Remote with Travel Options	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Self Paced Learning Portals	Designing	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 10+ people	No way	31k to 40k
Hybrid with <3Days at Office	Supports Learning	Self Paced Learning Portals	Designing	Sets target & expects delivery	Work with 5-6 people	Depends on the company	21k to 25k
Hybrid with <15 Days at Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Learning by observing others	Business Operations	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 2-3 people	No way	>50k
Everyday Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Expert Learning Programs	Teaching	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work alone	No way	>50k
Everyday Office	Supports Learning	Expert Learning Programs	Designing	Sets target & expects delivery	Work with 10+ people	Yes	>50k
Everyday Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Expert Learning Programs	Designing	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work alone	Depends on the company	26k to 30k
Hybrid with <10 Days at Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Expert Learning Programs	Manage End-to-End Projects	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 5-6 people	No way	>50k
Hybrid with <15 Days at Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Expert Learning Programs	Designing	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 2-3 people	Depends on the company	>50k
Fully Remote	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Self Paced Learning Portals	Teaching	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work alone	Depends on the company	>50k
Hybrid with <10 Days at Office	Supports Learning	Self Paced Learning Portals	Designing	Sets target & expects delivery	Work with 2-3 people	Depends on the company	>50k
Hybrid with <3Days at Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Self Paced Learning Portals	Teaching	Clear Communicator	Work with 2-3 people	Depends on the company	41k to 50k
Everyday Office	Supports Learning & Rewards Growth	Self Paced Learning Portals	Designing	Sets goal & helps achieving it	Work with 5-6 people	Depends on the company	>50k

Tools Used:

- Microsoft Excel
- Power Query (for splitting & transformation)



Exploratory Data Analytics (EDA)

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4

Questions Asked

1. What industries are Gen-Z most interested in pursuing careers in?
2. What are the top factors influencing Gen-Z's career choices?
3. What is the desired work environment for Gen-Z? (e.g., remote, hybrid, in-office)
4. How do financial goals, such as salary and benefits, impact career aspirations among Gen-Z?
5. What role do personal values and social impact play in career choices for Gen-Z?

Pivot Tables

1. What industries are Gen-Z most interested in pursuing careers in?			
Row Labels	Count of Career goal 1	Count of Career goal 2	Count of Career goal 3
Build and develop	7	7	7
Business Operatio	57	57	57
Design and Creativ	113	113	113
Design and Develo	11	11	11
Look deeply into C	6	6	6
Manage and drive	19	19	19
Manager who clea	576	576	556
Manager who expl	1920	1920	1841
Manager who sets	610	610	585
Manager who sets	210	210	204
Manager who sets	47	47	46
Teaching in any of	36	36	36
Grand Total	3612	3612	3481
Summary: - Gen-Z prefers business + tech-driven careers - Growing interest in freelancing & creative paths			

2. What are the top factors influencing Gen-Z's career choices?

Row Labels	Count of Career Influence Factor
Social Media like LinkedIn	340
People who have changed the world for better	823
People from my circle, but not family members	542
My Parents	1253
My Friends	8
Movies	5
Influencers who had successful careers	622
Grand Total	3593

Summary:

- Parents remain strongest influence
- Digital + aspirational figures shape decisions

3. What is the desired work environment for Gen-Z? (e.g., remote, hybrid,

Row Labels	Number of Respondents
Every Day Office Environment	759
Fully Remote with No option to visit offices	194
Fully Remote with Options to travel as and when	1012
Hybrid Working Environment with less than 10 c	53
Hybrid Working Environment with less than 15 c	92
Hybrid Working Environment with less than 3 d	525
Hybrid Working Environment with more than 15	977
Grand Total	3612

Summary:

- Gen-Z prefers **flexible work models**
- Remote + hybrid dominates over office

4. How do financial goals, such as salary and benefits, impact career aspirations among Gen-Z?

Row Labels	Count of Salary 0-3yrs	Row Labels	Count of Salary Post 5yrs
>50k	1042	>151k	802
11k to 15k	81	111k to 130k	494
16k to 20k	202	131k to 150k	378
21k to 25k	363	30k to 50k	160
26k to 30k	488	50k to 70k	428
31k to 40k	656	71k to 90k	682
41k to 50k	718	91k to 110k	668
5K to 10K	62	Grand Total	3612
Grand Total	3612		

Summary:

- Strong focus on **high earning potential**
- Expect **fast salary growth trajectory**

5. What role do personal values and social

Row Labels	Count of Social impact importance
1	435
2	211
3	327
4	285
5	789
6	377
7	421
8	376
9	134
10	257
Grand Total	3612

Summary:

- Values matter but are **secondary to growth**
- Prefer **balanced purpose + pay**

Data Analysis in SQL

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5



Questions Asked

- 1. What industries are Gen-Z most interested in pursuing careers in?**
- 2. What are the top factors influencing Gen-Z's career choices?**
- 3. What is the desired work environment for Gen-Z? (e.g., remote, hybrid, in-office)**
- 4. How do financial goals, such as salary and benefits, impact career aspirations among Gen-Z?**
- 5. What role do personal values and social impact play in career choices for Gen-Z?**



Solved SQL Queries

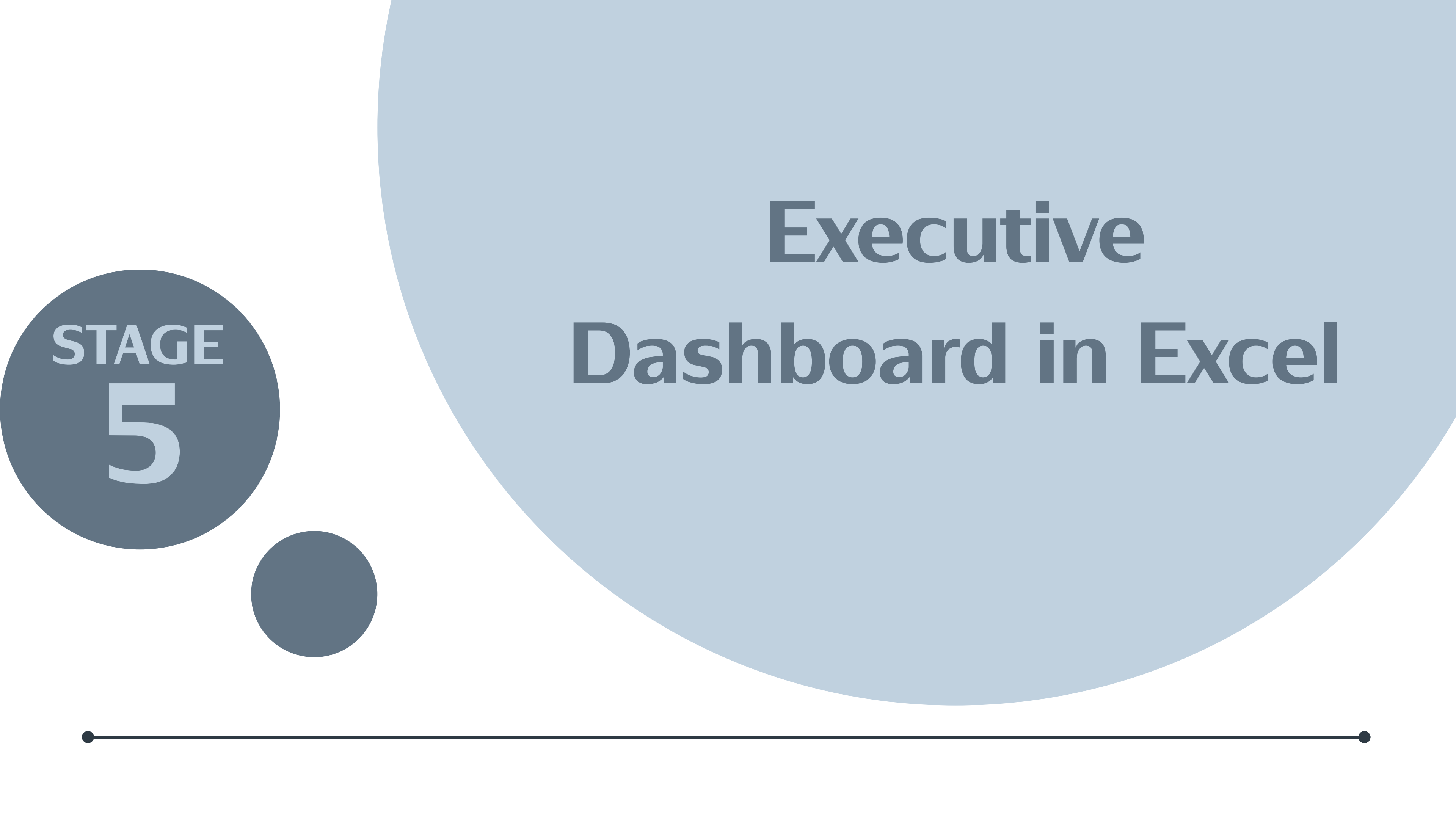
```
SELECT career, COUNT(*) AS total_count
FROM (
    SELECT [Career goal.1] AS career FROM GenZ
    UNION ALL
    SELECT [Career goal.2] FROM GenZ
    UNION ALL
    SELECT [Career goal.3] FROM GenZ
) AS combined
GROUP BY career
ORDER BY total_count DESC;
```

```
SELECT [Career Influence Factor], COUNT(*) AS total
FROM GenZ
GROUP BY [Career Influence Factor]
ORDER BY total DESC;
```

```
SELECT [Preferred work env], COUNT(*) AS total
FROM GenZ
GROUP BY [Preferred work env]
ORDER BY total DESC;
```

```
SELECT [Salary 0-3yrs], COUNT(*) AS total
FROM GenZ
GROUP BY [Salary 0-3yrs]
ORDER BY total DESC;
```

```
SELECT
    AVG([Social impact importance]) AS avg_score
FROM GenZ;
```



Executive Dashboard in Excel

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5

Gen-Z Career Aspirations Dashboard

Total Candidates

3613

Top Work Environment

Remote Work

Top Salary (3yrs)

>50k

Top Salary (5yrs)

>151k

Select Gender

Female

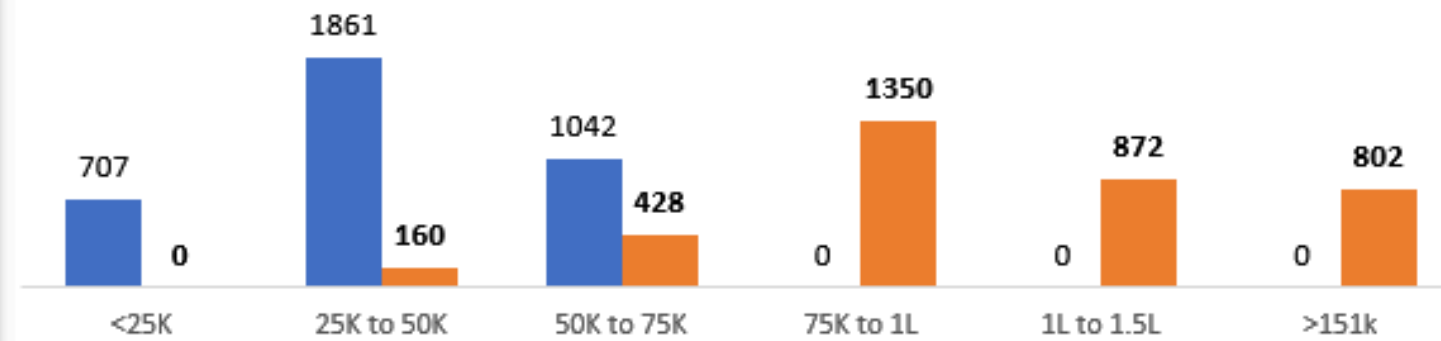
Male

Other

Transgen...

Salary Comparison

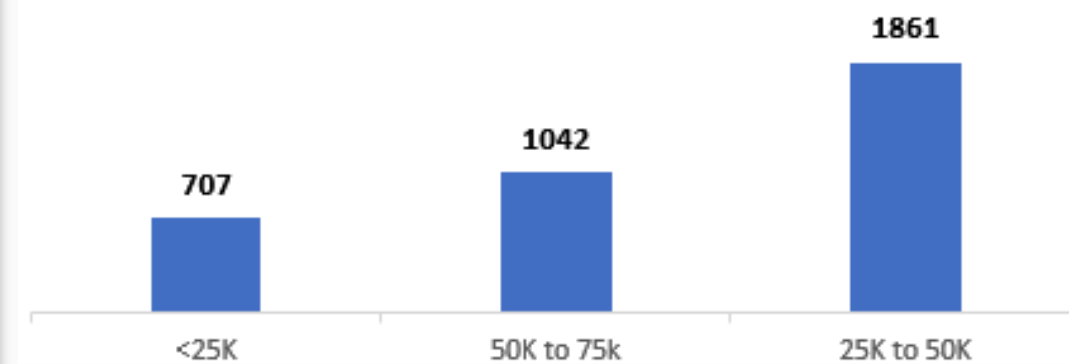
0-3yrs 5yrs



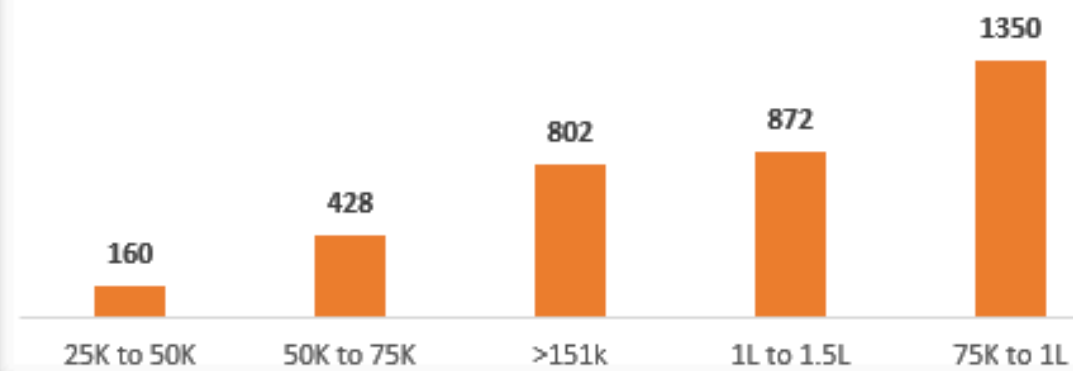
Career Influence Factors



Salary 0-3yrs

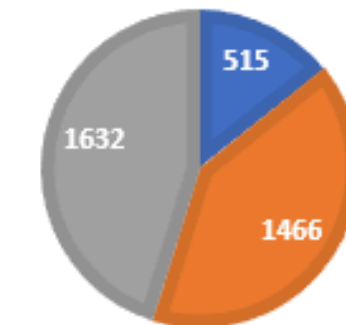


Salary in 5yrs

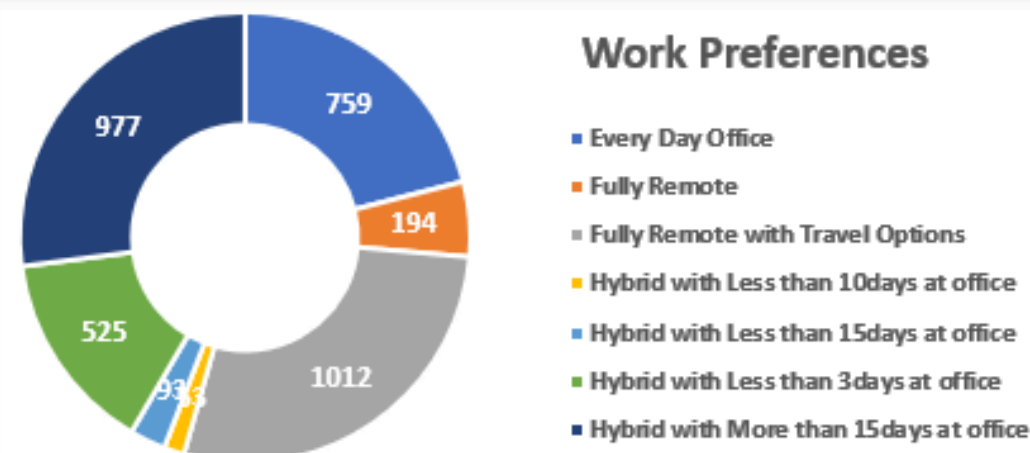


STUDY ABROAD INTENT

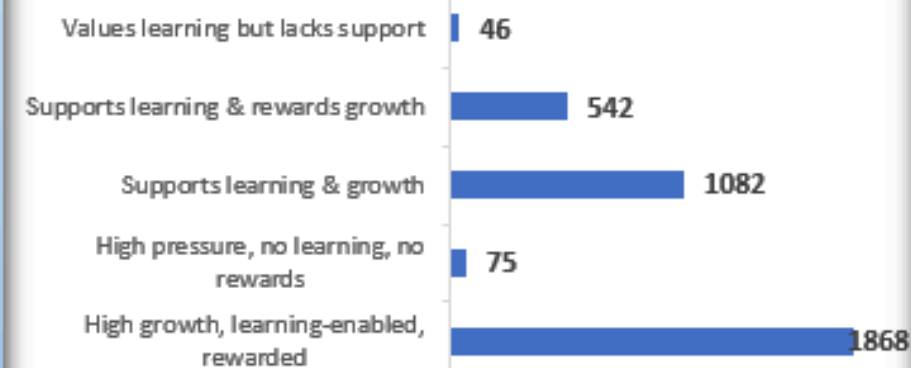
Cost Issues
No
Yes



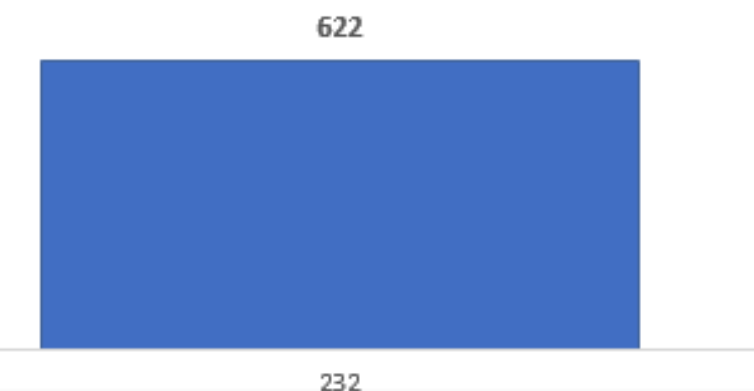
Work Preferences

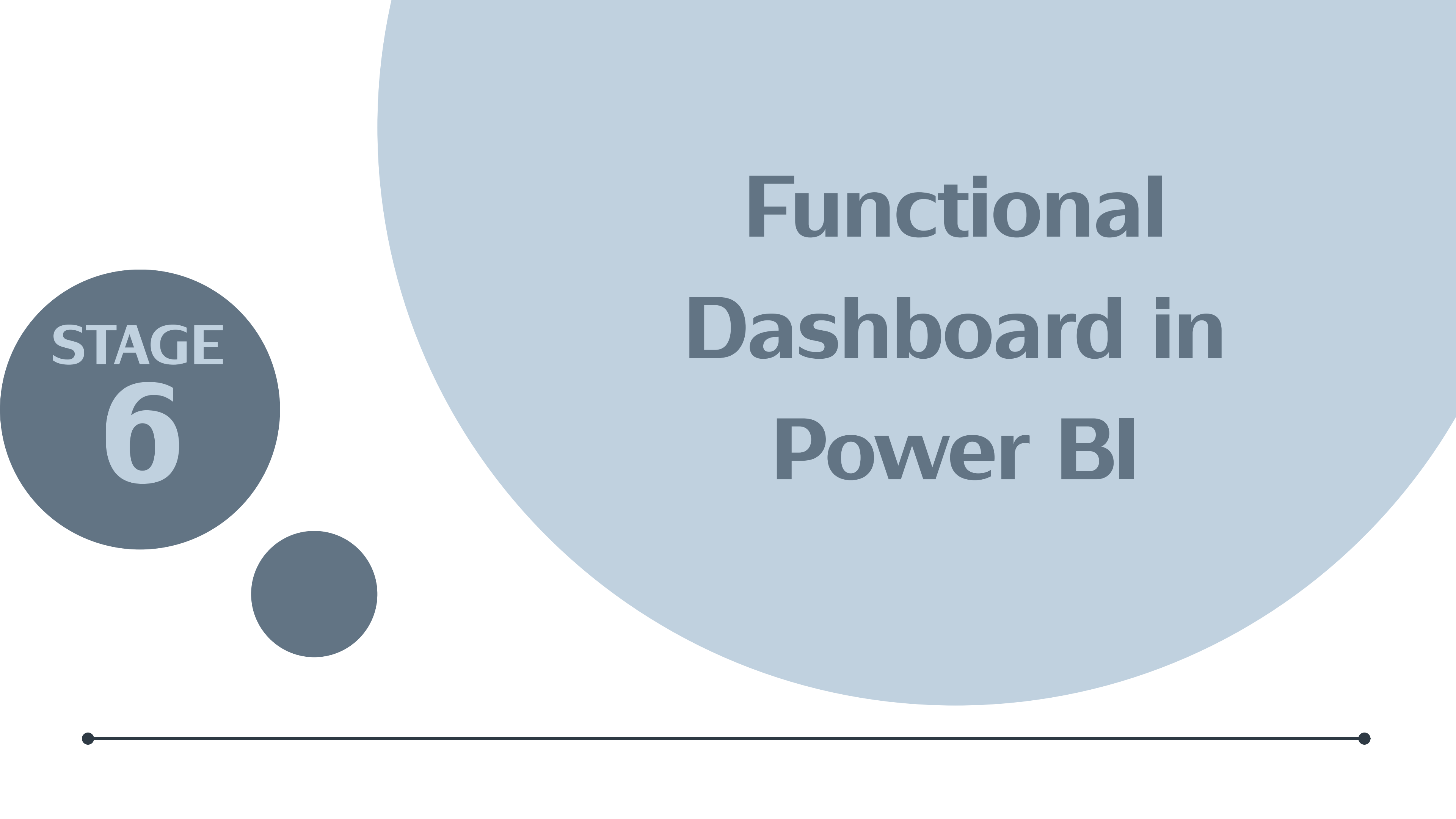


Preferred Employer Type



Preferred Manager Type





Functional Dashboard in Power BI

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6

Mission Aspirations of Gen-Z

Gen-Z Career Mission Insights

Candidates

3613

Pin Codes

1863

Select Gender

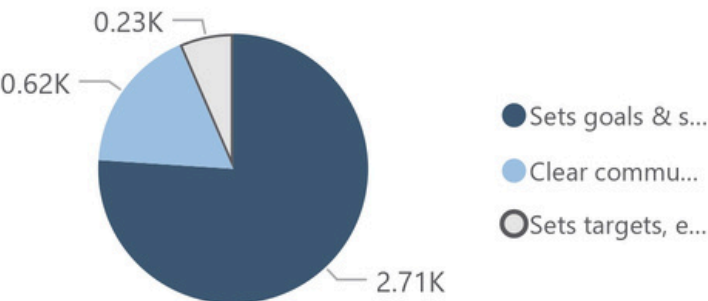
Female

Male

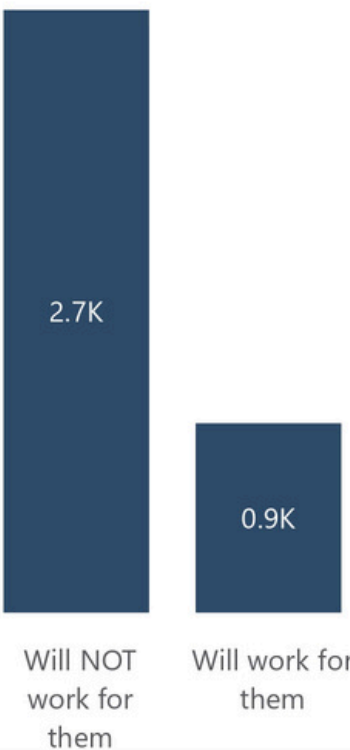
Other

Transgender

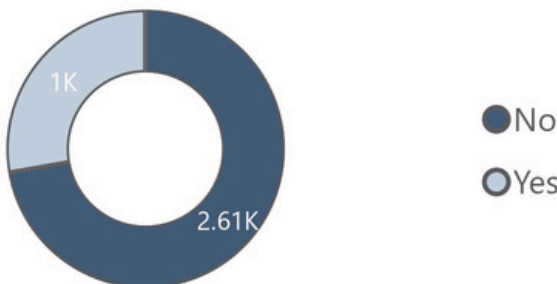
Top Manager preference by Gen-Z



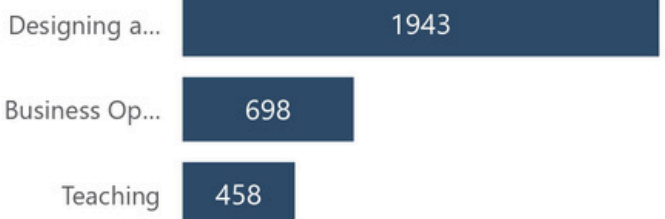
Impact of Mission Misaligned on Gen-Z



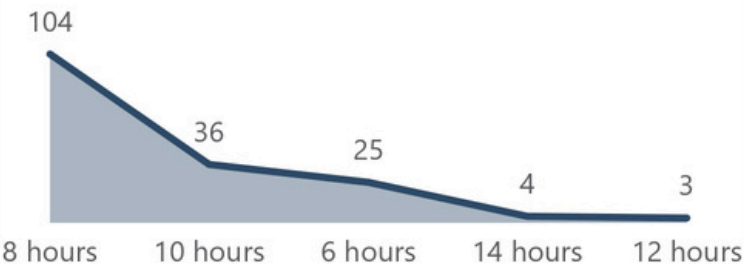
Gen-Z Willingness To Work Without Mission



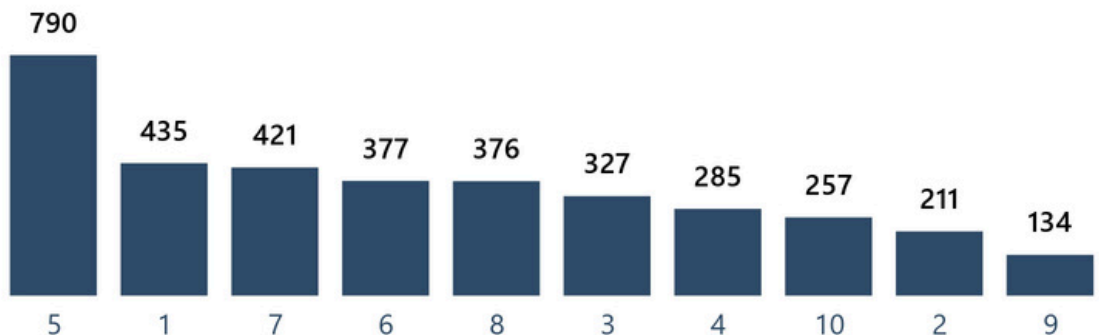
Top 3 Careers Gen-Z are aiming



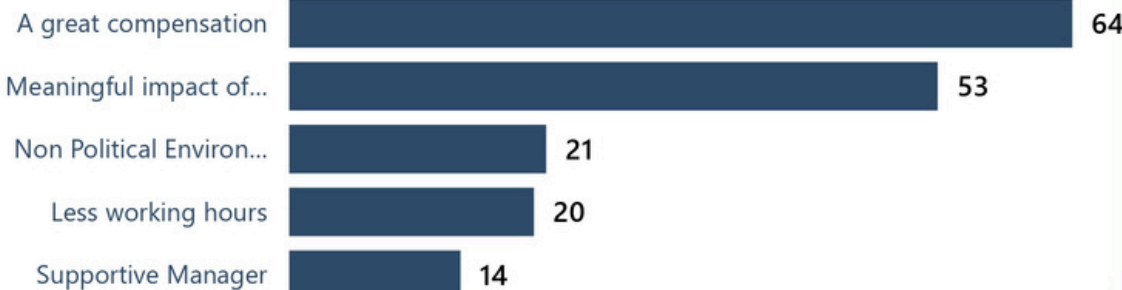
Preferred working hours a day for Gen-Z



Gen-Z Willing to work for low social impact companies

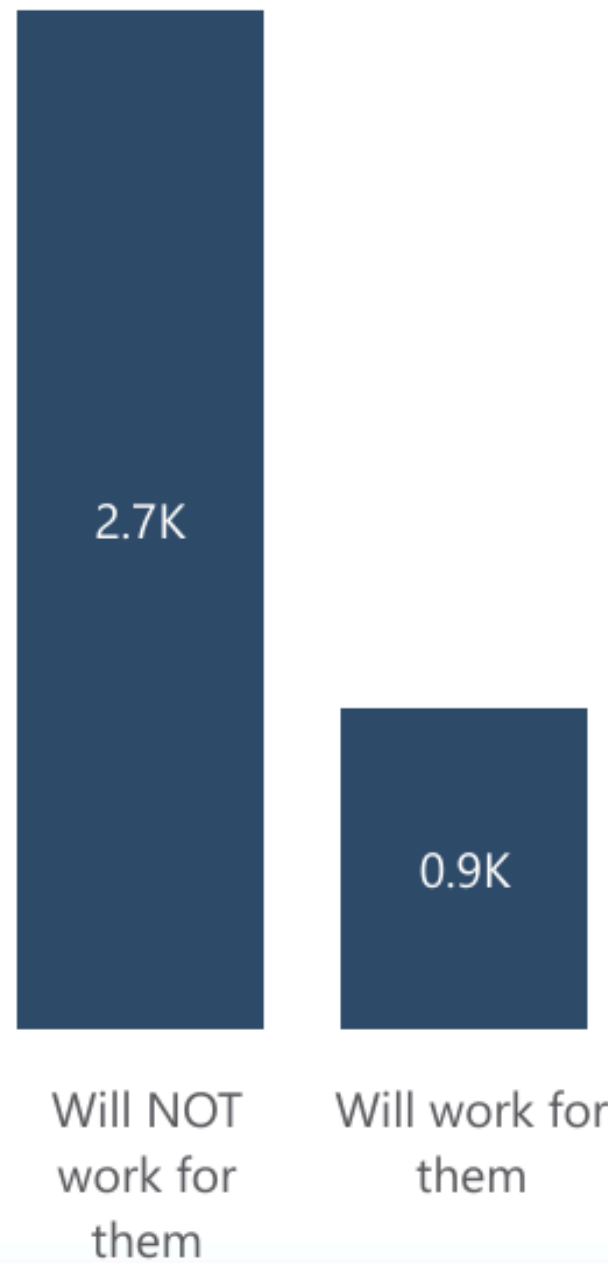


Workplace Happiness for Gen-Z



Insight

Impact of Mission Misaligned on Gen-Z



Problem:

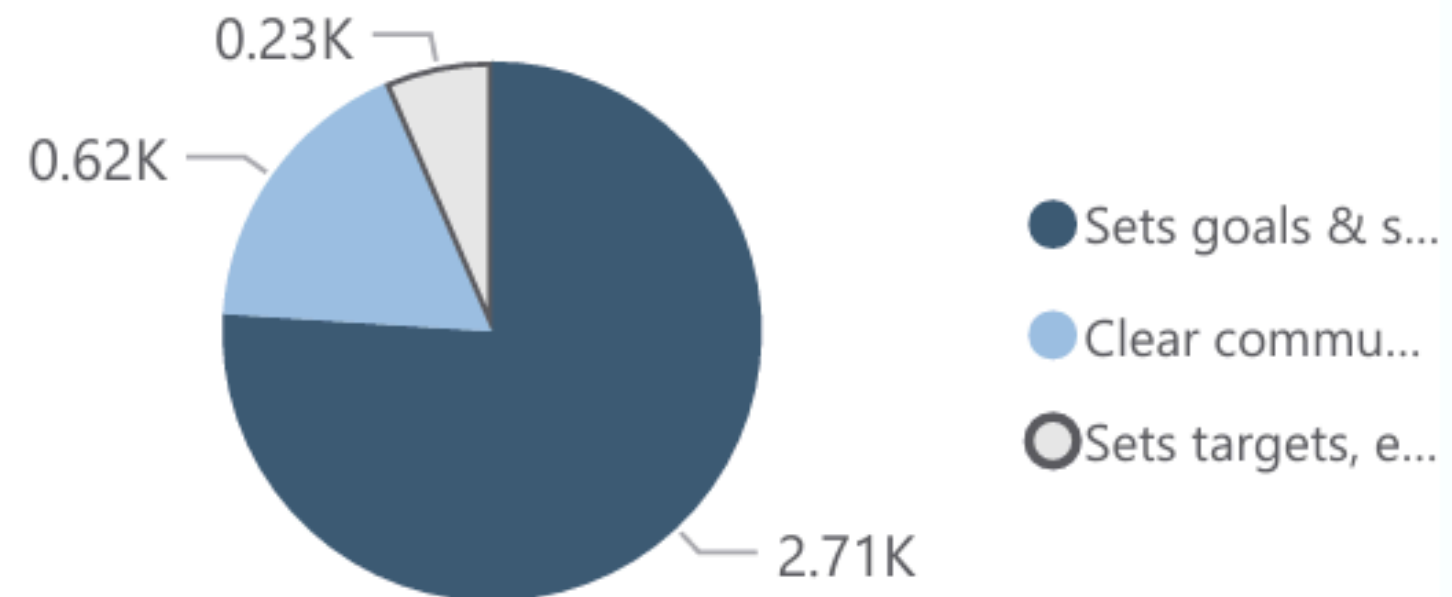
Lack of meaningful organizational mission alignment

Recommendations:

- Clearly define and communicate company purpose and values
- Align roles with social impact or larger goals
- Highlight real-world impact of work during hiring and onboarding

Insight

Top Manager preference by Gen-Z



Problem:

Poor leadership quality and unclear communication from managers

Recommendations:

- Invest in leadership training (focus on coaching & mentorship)
- Encourage transparent and frequent communication
- Train managers to set realistic, structured goals

Manager Aspirations of Gen-Z

Gen-Z Manager Preference Insights

Candidates

3613

Pin Codes

1863

Select Gender

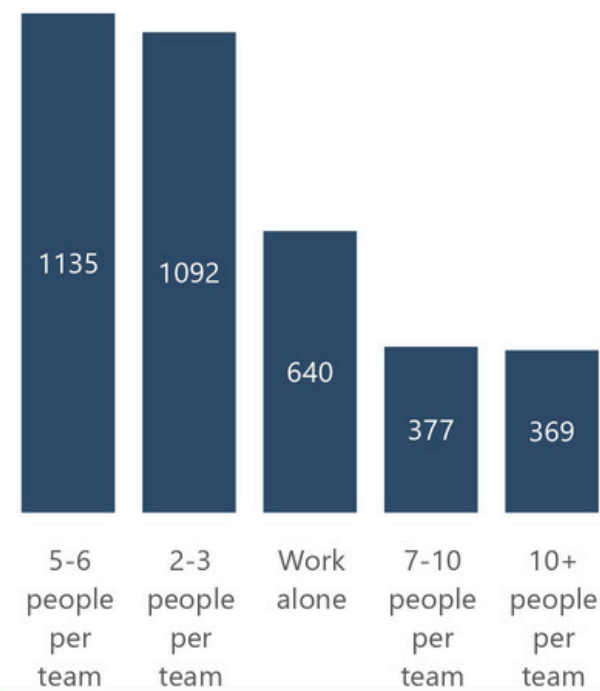
Female

Male

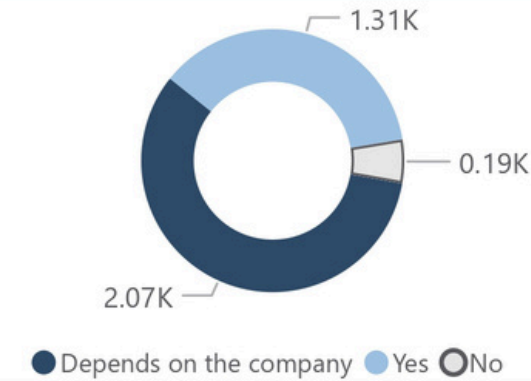
Other

Transgender

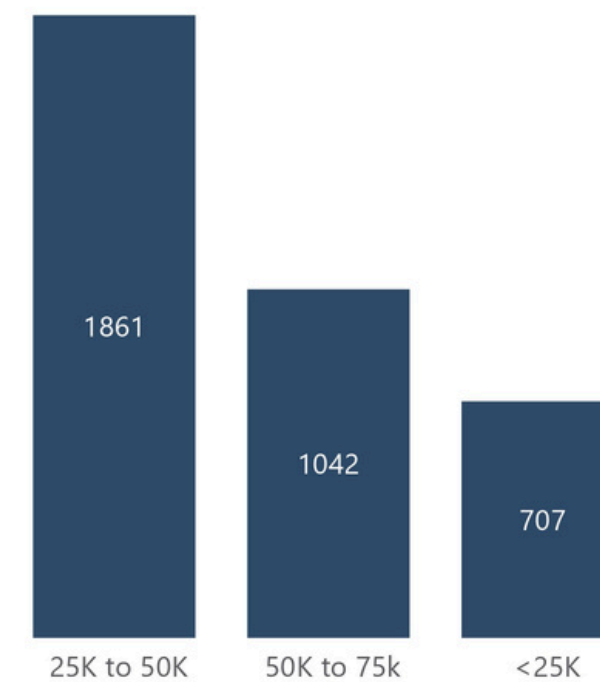
Gen-Z work setup preferences



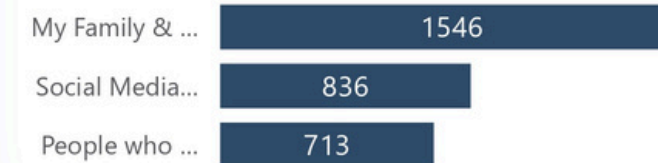
Work in a company for more than 3yr



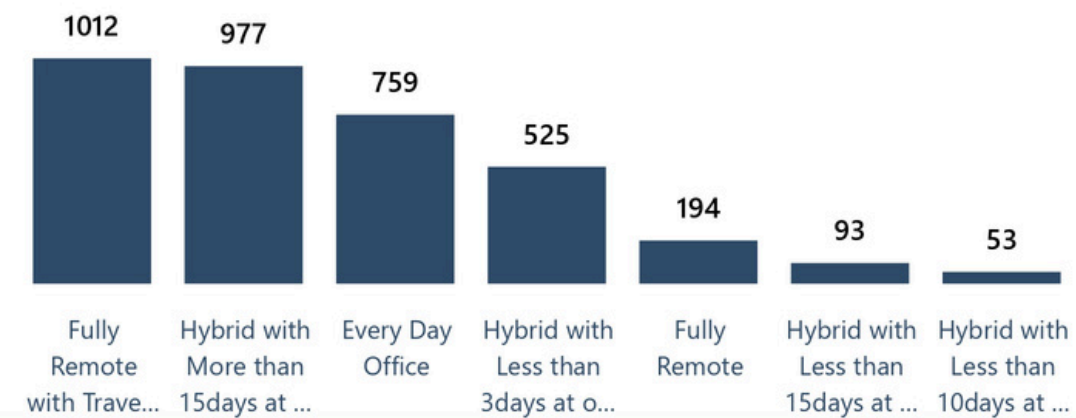
Gen-Z Salary expectations in 3yrs



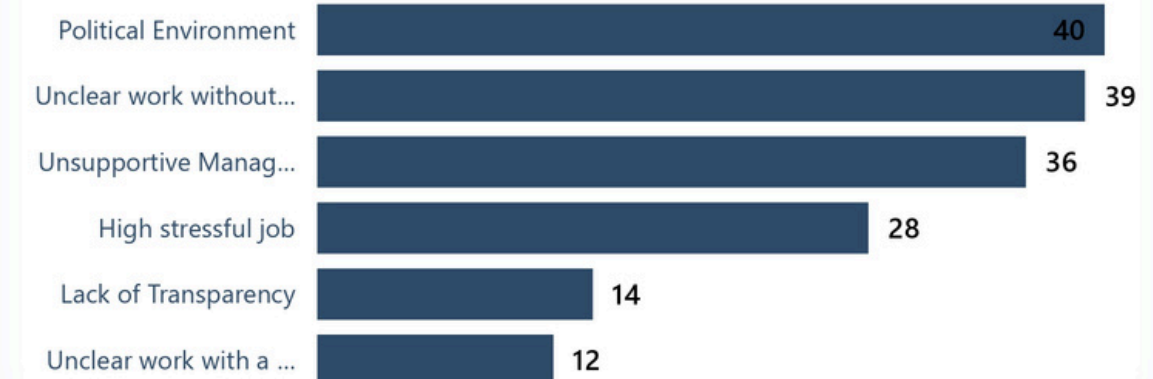
Top 3 Gen-Z career influencing factors



Preferred work environment for Gen-Z

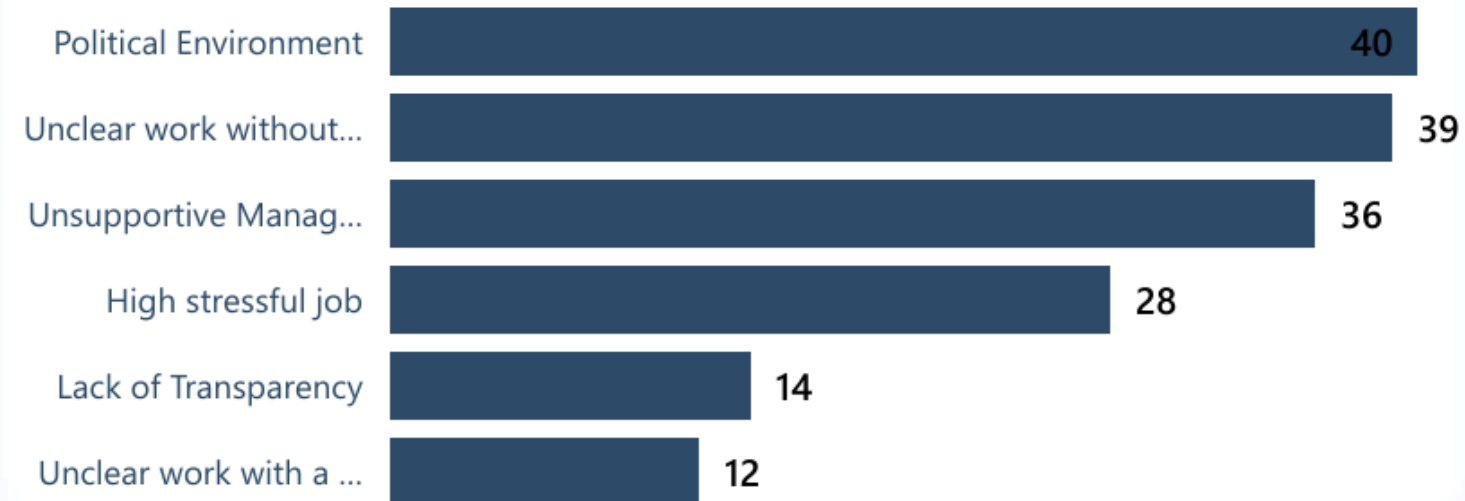


Frustration at workplace for Gen-Z



Insight

Frustration at workplace for Gen-Z



Problem:

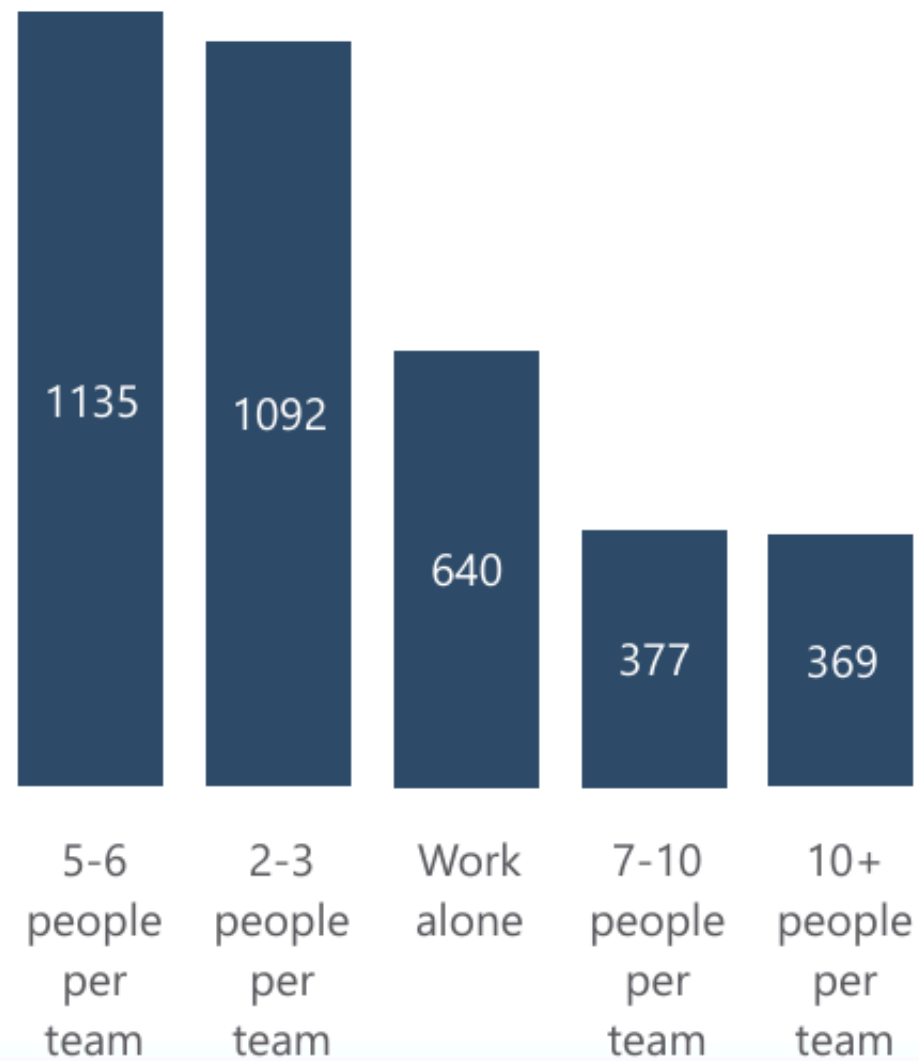
Toxic work culture and lack of clarity in roles

Recommendations:

- Build a transparent and neutral workplace culture
- Clearly define roles, responsibilities, and expectations
- Train managers to provide structured guidance and support

Insight

Gen-Z work setup preferences



Problem:

Inefficient large team structures reducing productivity and engagement

Recommendations:

- Organize work into smaller, agile teams
- Encourage ownership and accountability within small groups
- Reduce unnecessary hierarchy and team size complexity
- Promote collaboration through focused team units



Thank
You